BONUS · NEUROKIDS

Writing Journal

Creative writing prompts and exercises to spark your child's imagination

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INTRODUCTION

Tips for Young Writers

Everything you need to know before you start

Dear Parent or Guardian

This writing journal is designed to nurture your child's creativity and build confidence in self-expression. Here are some tips to help them get the most out of it:

- Let your child lead. Resist the urge to correct grammar or spelling during the creative process — those skills develop naturally with practice.
- Celebrate effort, not perfection. Praise the ideas, the story, the imagination — not the handwriting.
- Read their stories aloud together. Hearing their words spoken gives children a powerful sense of accomplishment.
- Keep it pressure-free. If your child wants to draw instead of write on some days, that counts too.
- Make writing time a cozy ritual — a favorite spot, a special pencil, maybe a snack.

Welcome, Young Writer!

> *This journal is YOUR space. Every page is waiting for YOUR ideas, YOUR stories, and YOUR imagination. Before you begin, here are five things to remember:*

1. There are no wrong answers — every idea is a good idea.
2. If you get stuck, close your eyes and imagine.
3. Draw first, then write about your drawing.
4. It is okay to ask for help with spelling.
5. Have fun!

PROMPT 1 — IF ANIMALS COULD TALK

“If animals could talk, my pet would say…”

- What would your pet complain about?
- What would it ask for?
- What secret would it tell you?
- What would it say about you?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 2 — THE SECRET DOOR

“The secret door in my room leads to…”

- What does the door look like?
- What do you see when you open it?
- Who lives there?
- Would you go through?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 3 — MY INVENTION

"I invented a machine that..."

- What does it look like?
- How does it work?
- Who would use it?
- What problem does it solve?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 4 — MY SUPERPOWER

"If I had a superpower, it would be..."

- What would you do first?
- Would you tell anyone?
- How would you help people?
- What would you name yourself?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 5 — THE BEST DAY EVER

“The best day ever would include…”

- Where would you go?
- Who would be with you?
- What would you eat?
- What would make it special?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 6 — TALKING TO THE MOON

“Last night, the Moon told me a secret…”

- What did the Moon’s voice sound like?
- What was the secret?
- What did you say back?
- Did anyone else hear it?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 7 — THE MAGIC BACKPACK

“I found a backpack that gives me anything I need…”

- What was the first thing that appeared?
- Where did you take it?
- Did it ever give you something surprising?
- Would you share it?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 8 — UNDER THE SEA

"I woke up and I could breathe underwater..."

- What did you see first?
- Did you make any sea creature friends?
- What was the most amazing thing?
- How did it feel?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 9 — THE TINY WORLD

"I shrank to the size of an ant..."

- What looked different?
- What was scary?
- What was exciting?
- How did you get back to normal?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 10 — TIME TRAVEL

“I traveled back in time to…”

- What year did you go to?
- What did you see?
- Did you meet anyone famous?
- What did you bring back?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 11 — MY SECRET HIDEOUT

“I built the perfect secret hideout…”

- Where is it?
- What’s inside?
- Who is allowed in?
- What’s the password?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 12 — THE FRIENDLY MONSTER

“A friendly monster moved in next door…”

- What does it look like?
- What does it eat?
- What do you do together?
- What’s its name?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 13 — CHEF FOR A DAY

“If I could cook anything in the world…”

- What would you make?
- Who would eat it?
- What ingredients would you need?
- What would it taste like?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 14 — THE WISH

“A genie gave me three wishes…”

- What was your first wish?
- Your second?
- Your third?
- Did any wish surprise you?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 15 — ANIMAL SCHOOL

“At animal school, the teacher is a…”

- What subjects do they teach?
- Who are your classmates?
- What’s recess like?
- What’s for lunch?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 16 — CLOUD SHAPES

“I was lying in the grass looking at clouds when I saw…”

- What shape was it?
- Did it change?
- What story did the clouds tell?
- Who was with you?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 17 — THE TREASURE MAP

"I found a treasure map in my attic..."

- Where does the map lead?
- What dangers are on the way?
- What is the treasure?
- Who goes with you?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 18 — INVISIBLE FOR A DAY

"If I were invisible for one day..."

- Where would you go?
- What would you see?
- Would you play tricks?
- How would you turn visible again?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 19 — MY ROBOT FRIEND

“I built a robot that…”

- What can it do?
- What does it look like?
- What’s its name?
- What is its favorite thing to do?

Draw it here:

PROMPT 20 — A LETTER TO MY FUTURE SELF

“Dear future me…”

- What do you hope you will remember?
- What do you want to be doing?
- What advice would you give?
- What makes you happy right now?

Draw it here:

BONUS

Story Starter Cards

Pick one and keep writing!

1. The old clock on the wall suddenly started ticking backwards...

2. When I opened my lunchbox, a tiny dragon flew out...

3. The last tree in the city started to glow...

4. My shadow stood up and walked away...

5. The library books began whispering to each other...

6. A staircase appeared in the middle of the playground...

TEMPLATE

My Story Planning Template

Plan your story before you write it

My Main Character

Name, age, what they look like, what they are good at:

The Setting

Where does the story happen? When? What does it look like?

The Problem

What goes wrong? What does the character need?

The Solution

How does the character fix it? Who helps? How does it end?

WORD BANK

Awesome Adjectives

Use these words to make your writing more vivid

CATEGORY	WORDS TO TRY
Size	tiny, huge, enormous, miniature, gigantic
Feelings	excited, nervous, proud, curious, brave, worried, delighted
Colors	scarlet, golden, silver, midnight, emerald, crimson
Texture	smooth, rough, slimy, fluffy, prickly, silky

Writer's Tip

Instead of saying "The dog was big," try "The **enormous** dog towered over me." One strong adjective can change your whole sentence!

WORD BANK

Vivid Verbs & Feelings Words

Swap boring verbs for exciting ones

Vivid Verbs

Instead of “ran” or “said,” try one of these:

dashed · whispered · soared · crept · tumbled · shimmered · roared · tiptoed · pounced · glided

Feelings Words

WORD	WHEN YOU FEEL THIS WAY
Happy	When something great happens
Sad	When something makes you cry
Angry	When something is unfair
Scared	When something is unknown
Excited	When something fun is coming
Proud	When you did something well
Grateful	When someone is kind
Confused	When things don’t make sense

ALL ABOUT YOU

About the Author

Every great writer has a page about themselves

Author Name:

Age:

Draw yourself here:

My favorite thing to write about:

When I grow up, I want to be:

My favorite book is:

One fun fact about me:

Author signature:

Next Step

Open the NeuroKids main guide and pick your first weekly activity plan to keep the learning going!